Weekend Warrior

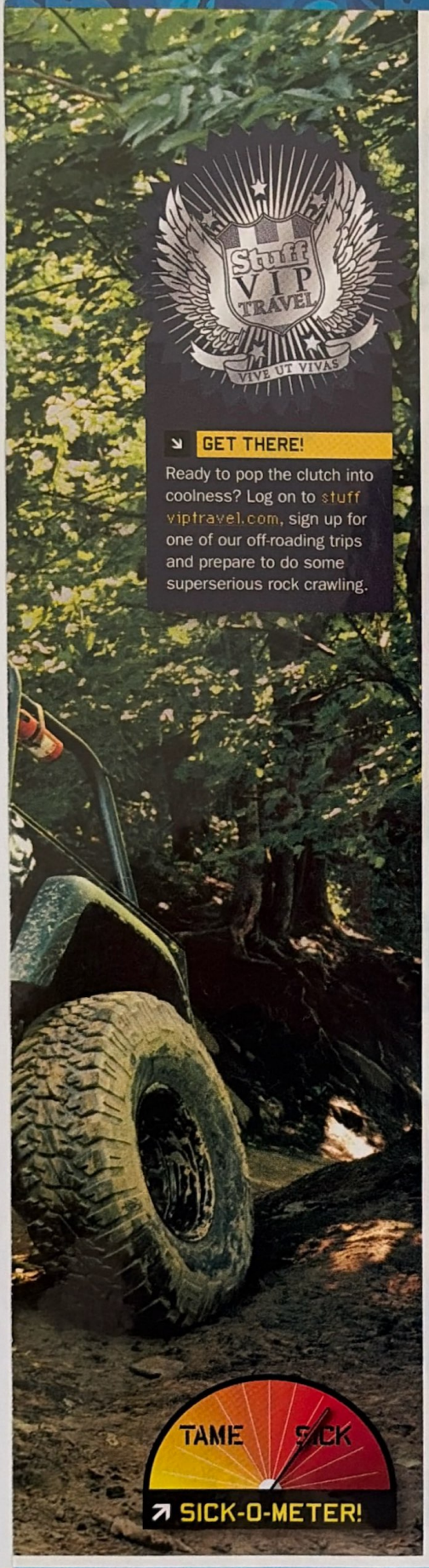
VE THREE DAYS AND COUNTING...

OFF-ROAD RENDEZVOUS!

Downshift into four-wheel drive and leave the pavement in the dust.

The average schmuck drives 10,000 miles a year, steering his precious SUV "off-road" only when flipping a U-turn or clumsily navigating a dirt parking lot. Don't become a sissiness statistic: Skip the manicured highways, touch-free car washes and scented air fresheners and get that 4x4 to the nearest boulder-strewn jeep trail. Not sure if your stock rig can handle the rugged terrain? Here's how to get it into peak axle-tweaking form.

↗ Learn how to parallel park, for Chrissakes.



GET THERE!

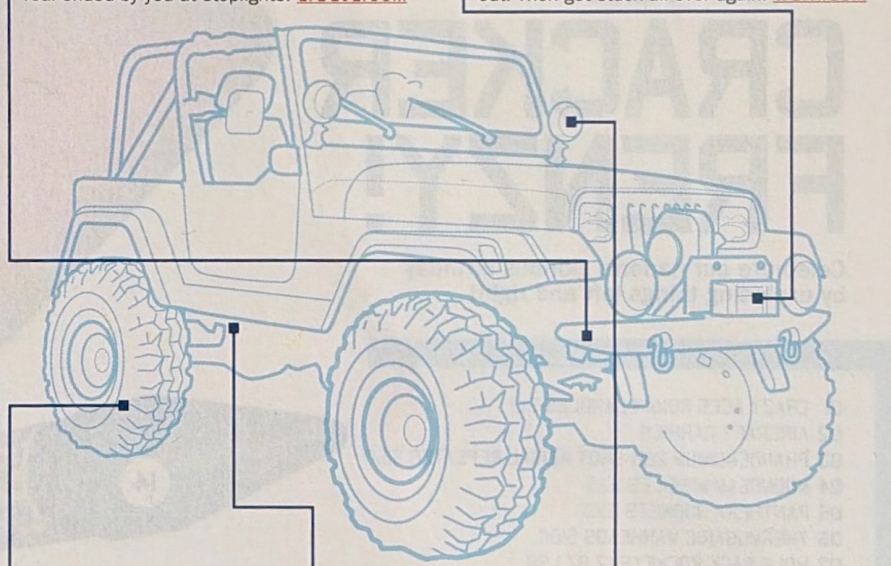
Ready to pop the clutch into coolness? Log on to stuffviptravel.com, sign up for one of our off-roading trips and prepare to do some superserious rock crawling.

SICK-O-METER!

MAKE THY CHARIOT BURLY WITH THESE AUDACIOUS ADD-ONS

BUMP UP!
ARB DELUXE WINCH BUMPER / $789
A winch bumper, or "bull bar," is a heavy-duty component designed to house your winch and protect your car from engine-crumpling impacts on the trail. In other words, it's a safety device, but it also makes other drivers scared of getting rear-ended by you at stoplights. arbusa.com

WINCH OUT!
WARN 9.5TI THERMOMETRIC SELF-RECOVERY WINCH / $1,140
If your rig gets stuck in a ditch and you don't have an army of 'roid-raging linebackers to push you out, simply rope your winch cable around the sturdiest thing you can find and reel yourself out. Then get stuck all over again! warn.com



ROLL UP!
INTERCO SUPER SWAMPER TSL/BOGGER 33x12.5-15LT / $200 EACH
Why do you need huge tires? Aside from the fact that they instantly quadruple your vehicle's coolness factor, their deep treads and massive footprints provide essential traction. Deflate slightly for even better grip. intercotire.com

GET LIFTED!
RANCHO RS9000X SHOCK ABSORBER / $99 EACH
Having an assload of ground clearance is key when you're off-road, and one way to boost your rock-crawling performance is to get a suspension lift. These beefy shocks will hoist your undercarriage out of harm's way and make you feel short. gorancho.com

SHINE ON!
PIAA 580 SERIES DRIVING LAMP / $300
Your stock lights aren't as bright as you think, and, come dusk, even those high beams can let you down on a narrow off-road trail. To illuminate those hidden rocks, steep angles and deceptive ruts, you need retina-searing lamps. The difference is night and day—literally. piaa.com